

DESIGNING A DUNGEON

This is a shortened version of the step-by-step method for designing a dungeon first introduced in the D&D Basic rules. New expanded charts are given for treasure found in unguarded rooms, for higher level NPC parties, and for wandering monsters, which extend the old charts beyond the third dungeon level.

A. CHOOSE A SCENARIO.

A scenario or story about the background, history and current rumors of the dungeon should be written to give purpose and direction to the dungeon and its design.

B. DECIDE ON A SETTING.

To help set the mood of the dungeon and to give further direction in designing a dungeon, a location in the wilderness should be chosen as well as what the dungeon ruins used to be, such as an old castle, an abandoned mine, or a series of catacombs.

C. DECIDE ON SPECIAL MONSTERS TO BE USED.

The DM should decide what monsters live in the dungeon and which will be most commonly encountered, such as a lair of goblins and the vermin, such as rats and snakes, which might inhabit the lair with them.

D. DRAW THE MAP OF THE DUNGEON.

Using the setting as a guideline for the shape of the dungeon and the type of rooms and corridors which might be found there, draw the major encounter areas of the dungeon, the corridors which link them and the entrance to the dungeon.

E. STOCK THE DUNGEON.

First the DM should design any major encounter areas and the monsters, treasures, traps and special situations which may be encountered there. Then the DM may stock the remaining minor areas with monsters and treasure using the following system. Roll 1d6 on the CONTENTS table, and then roll a second d6 for TREASURE based on the results of the first roll.

First Roll: CONTENTS Second Roll: TREASURE?

Die Roll	Result	Die Roll	Monster	Trap	Empty
1-2	Monster	1	Yes	Yes	Yes
3	Trap	2	Yes	Yes	No
4	Special	3	Yes	No	No
5-6	Empty	4-6	No	No	No

A **Monster** result means that the DM should roll on a **Wandering Monsters** table to determine the type. A **Trap** may be in an empty room or on treasure. A **Special** is anything not exactly a trap, but placed for special reasons, such as a moaning room, a spinning room, illusions, and so forth. The DM should design his or her own traps and specials.

Treasure

The DM may assign treasure to monsters, or place treasure in rooms, as he or she wishes. If random rolls are used, the table below lists treasure amounts found in unguarded rooms (those without a monster) on all dungeon levels. Since treasure is an important factor for gaining experience at higher levels the DM may wish to not allow unguarded treasures below the 8th level. If a monster is present, use the Treasure Type listing (p. X43) for the monster to find the amount of treasure in the room.

Unguarded Treasure

Dungeon Level	Silver Pieces	Gold Pieces	Gems/Jewelry	Magic Items
1	100 (x1d6)	50%; 10 (x1d6)	5%/2% (x1d6)	2%; any 1
2-3	100 (x1d12)	50%; 100 (x1d6)	10%/5% (x1d6)	8%; any 1
4-5	1000 (x1d6)	200 (x1d6)	20%/10% (x1d6)	10%; any 1
6-7	2000 (x1d6)	500 (x1d6)	30%/15% (x1d6)	15%; any 1
8-9	5000 (x1d6)	1000 (x1d6)	40%/20% (x1d12)	20%; any 1

CREATING AN NPC PARTY

If the DM is using NPC parties as Wandering Monsters or as planned encounters, creating these parties in advance will save time. The DM may choose the members of an NPC party, or use random rolls. Parties of higher-level NPCs (Adventurers) can be created randomly with the following system.

The composition, level, and alignment of a NPC party (Adventurers) can be randomly determined by using the following steps:

- Roll 1d6 + 3 to determine the number appearing.
- Determine the class of each by rolling 1d8, then roll 1d6 adding the necessary modifiers to determine level:

CLASS	LEVEL
1 cleric	4-9 (1d6 + 3)
2 dwarf	7-12 (1d6 + 6)
3 elf	3-8 (1d6 + 2)
4 fighter	4-9 (1d6 + 3)
5 halfling	3-8 (1d6 + 2)
6 magic-user	4-9 (1d6 + 3)
7 thief	5-10 (1d6 + 4)
8 fighter	6-11 (1d6 + 5)
- Determine alignment of each NPC with 1d6:
 - 1, 2 lawful
 - 3, 4 neutral
 - 5, 6 chaotic
- Randomly determine or choose any spells for any magic-users, elves or clerics in the party.
- Randomly determine possible magic items for the NPCs (see below).
- Decide on a marching order for the group.
- If encountered in the wilderness, there is a 75% chance that the NPC party will be mounted.

NPC Magic Items

In general, NPCs should have about the same number of items as a player character of the same level. Magic can be assigned to match the power of the NPC or it can be rolled randomly. The chance of any NPC of 1st level or greater possessing magic items is 5% per level (maximum chance 95%), checking on *each* magic item suitable:

Swords	Scroll
Armor	Wand/Staff/Rod
Miscellaneous Weapon	Miscellaneous Magic
Potion	

If an NPC cannot use an item, the NPC should not have it (do not re-roll). The DM may reduce or change the magic items rolled to prevent the players from getting powerful magic items too easily. Note also that NPCs will use their magic intelligently against the party when in combat. Furthermore, NPCs never willingly give magic items to players, nor should a **charm** spell cause them to surrender such items. Players should obtain magic items from NPCs only through barter, trickery, or force.